

Main Course

Bite 1 – What’s Really in Your Heart, 1 Kings 3:8–9 (WEB)

⁸ Your servant is among your people which you have chosen, a great people, that can’t be counted nor numbered for multitude. ⁹ Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours?

Instead of asking for more money, more power, or revenge on his enemies, Solomon asks for an **understanding heart** so he can lead God’s people well. What he asks for shows what matters most to him.

Reflection Question

What do your prayers say about what you care about most?

Bite 2 – God’s Response, 1 Kings 3:10–12 (WEB)

¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹ God said to him, “Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have asked riches for yourself, nor have asked the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice, ¹² behold, I have done according to your word. Behold, I have given you a wise and understanding heart, so that there has been no one like you before you, and after you none will arise like you.

God is **pleased** with Solomon’s request. He gives Solomon the wisdom he asked for, and later adds riches and honor too. God loves when we want what He wants—especially when we ask for wisdom to serve others.

Reflection Question

Where in your life do you most need God’s wisdom right now—school, friendships, money, family, decisions?

Bite 3 – Learning to Seek Wisdom, Proverbs 2:1–6 (WEB)

¹ My son, if you will receive my words, and store up my commandments within you, ² so as to turn your ear to wisdom, and apply your heart to understanding; ³ yes, if you call out for discernment, and lift up your voice for understanding; ⁴ if you seek her as silver, and search for her as for hidden treasures: ⁵ then you will understand the fear of Yahweh, and find the knowledge of God. ⁶ For Yahweh gives wisdom. Out of his mouth comes knowledge and understanding.

Later, Solomon teaches others how to chase wisdom. Wisdom isn't something you sit around and wait for—it's something you **seek like treasure**. Real wisdom comes from God.

Reflection Question

What is one practical way you can start “seeking wisdom like treasure” this week?

Dessert

Solomon's story reminds us:

- What we ask God for shows what's in our heart.
- God loves to give wisdom to people who want to use it His way.

Reflection Question

Finish this quietly: “Lord, help me want _____ more than _____.”

To-Go Box

- God isn't just listening to **what** you ask—He sees **why** you ask.
- Wisdom is worth more than status or stuff.
- When you don't know what to do, asking God for an **understanding heart** is one of the best prayers you can pray.

Write one sentence:

“God, please give me wisdom about _____.”

 **Prayer**

“God, thank You for the way You answered Solomon when he asked for wisdom. Please forgive me for the times I chase stuff more than I chase Your heart. Give me an understanding heart to make good choices, treat people right, and honor You in my decisions. Help me to seek wisdom like treasure. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

 **Personal Prayer Space**

Write your own short prayer asking God for wisdom in a real situation you’re facing:

 **Activity – “Ask Big” (Youth)**

Fill in the blanks from the lesson:

1. God appeared to _____ in a dream and said, “Ask for what you want Me to give you.”
2. Solomon asked for an _____ **heart** to judge God’s people.
3. God was _____ that Solomon asked for wisdom instead of riches or revenge.
4. In Proverbs 2, we are told to seek _____ like silver and hidden treasure.

BM1 – Lesson 3: Jesus

 Prayer as the First Resort

 **Theme:** Talking to God before everything falls apart

 **Background Text:** Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8

 **Key Verse:** **Luke 18:1 (WEB)**

“He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;”

Appetizer – Jesus Pulled Away to Pray, Luke 5:15–16 (WEB)

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed.

Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. People wanted to hear Jesus and be healed. But instead of just doing more and more, Jesus **chose to pull away and pray**. When things got busier, He didn’t pray less—He prayed **more**.

Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first: sleep, fun, prayer, or something else?

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Bite 1 – “Lord, Teach Us to Pray”, Luke 11:1–4 (WEB)

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.
May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.’”

Main Course

Bite 1 – Midnight Praise, Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

At their worst moment—midnight, in pain, chained—they choose to:

- **Pray**
- **Sing hymns to God**

Everyone else is listening. Their worship turns the prison into a **sanctuary**.

Reflection Question

If someone listened to you in your “midnight moments,” what would they hear—complaints, silence, or praise?

Bite 2 – The Shaking, Acts 16:26–28 (WEB)

²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened and everyone’s bonds were loosened. ²⁷ The jailer, being awakened out of his sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, “Don’t harm yourself, for we are all here!”

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

But the first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stay, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line.